Active Battery Cell Equalization System Using Flyback Converters

MATLAB/Simulink Implementation for Electric Vehicles

A Mini Project Report

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Abstract

This project proposes the design and implementation of an Active Battery Cell Equalization System for Electric Vehicle applications using MATLAB/Simulink. The system addresses the critical challenge of cell voltage imbalance in series-connected lithium-ion battery packs through flyback converter topology enabling bidirectional energy transfer between cells. The proposed methodology employs intelligent control algorithms for voltage monitoring, differential calculation, and selective converter activation to redistribute energy from higher-charged cells to lower-charged cells.

The simulation results demonstrate successful voltage convergence from an initial spread of 0.90V to a final spread of 34mV (96.2% improvement) within 600 seconds, well exceeding the industry standard of 50mV. The system maintains stable operation under discharge loads and achieves an estimated efficiency greater than 85%. This active balancing approach extends battery lifespan by 20-30%, improves driving range through maximum capacity utilization, and enhances safety by preventing voltage extremes.

Keywords: Active cell balancing, Flyback converter, Battery management system, Electric vehicles, Energy transfer, Lithium-ion batteries, State of charge

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1 Introduction

1.1 Background

Electric Vehicle (EV) battery packs utilize series-connected lithium-ion cells to achieve the required voltage levels for traction motors. A typical EV battery pack may contain hundreds of cells connected in series and parallel configurations. For a 4-cell series pack, the nominal voltage is approximately 14.8V (3.7V per cell), with each individual cell operating within a safe voltage range of 2.5V (minimum) to 4.2V (maximum).

However, inherent manufacturing tolerances create capacity variations of $\pm 5\%$ between cells from the same production batch. Additionally, operational factors such as temperature gradients across the battery pack, differential self-discharge rates, and varying aging patterns lead to the development of cell-to-cell voltage imbalances over time. In series configurations, this imbalance becomes particularly problematic because the weakest cell becomes the limiting factor for the entire pack, forcing premature termination of charge-discharge cycles when any individual cell reaches its voltage limits.

1.2 Motivation

The motivation for developing an active battery cell equalization system stems from several critical challenges in modern EV battery management:

1. **Capacity Underutilization:** Voltage imbalance prevents full utilization of the battery pack's theoretical capacity. When one cell reaches its voltage limit, the entire series string must stop charging or discharging, even if other cells have remaining capacity.

2. **Reduced Driving Range:** Premature charge/discharge termination directly reduces the effective driving range of electric vehicles, as the total usable energy is limited by the weakest cell rather than the pack average.

3. **Accelerated Degradation:** Cells operating at voltage extremes experience accelerated degradation. High-voltage cells suffer from increased electrolyte decomposition, while low-voltage cells face lithium plating risks during charging.

4. **Safety Concerns:** Severe voltage imbalances can lead to overcharge (above 4.2V) or over-discharge (below 2.5V) conditions, which may trigger thermal runaway events and pose serious safety risks.

5. **Economic Impact:** Battery pack replacement is one of the most significant maintenance costs for EVs. Extending battery lifespan through effective balancing directly improves the total cost of ownership.

1.3 Project Objectives

The primary objectives of this project are:

- Design and implement an active cell balancing system using flyback converter topology

- Develop intelligent control algorithms for automatic converter activation and duty cycle adjustment
- Achieve voltage convergence within industry-standard tolerance (less than 50mV)
- Validate system performance through comprehensive MATLAB/Simulink simulation
- Analyze energy transfer efficiency and balancing speed
- Evaluate system stability under varying load conditions

1.4 Report Organization

This report is organized as follows: Section 2 presents the problem statement and literature review. Section 3 describes the proposed methodology including system architecture, control algorithms, and component modeling. Section 4 details the theoretical design calculations. Section 5 discusses the simulation setup and implementation. Section 6 presents the comprehensive simulation results. Section 7 analyzes the system performance. Finally, Section 8 provides conclusions and recommendations for future work.

2 Problem Statement

2.1 Cell Imbalance in Series Battery Packs

The primary challenge addressed in this project is voltage imbalance among series-connected lithium-ion cells in EV battery packs. Manufacturing variations create initial capacity differences between cells, which are then amplified by operational factors including:

- **Temperature Gradients:** Cells in different physical locations experience different operating temperatures, affecting their internal resistance and capacity
- **Differential Self-Discharge:** Variations in self-discharge rates cause some cells to lose charge faster than others during storage
- **Non-Uniform Aging:** Different usage patterns and thermal histories lead to varying degradation rates
- **Connection Resistance:** Slight differences in contact resistance affect current distribution

These factors combine to create significant voltage disparities during operation, with initial imbalances as large as 0.9V observed in typical scenarios.

2.2 Consequences of Imbalance

The consequences of cell imbalance manifest in three critical areas:

2.2.1 Performance Degradation

- **Reduced Effective Capacity:** The usable capacity of the battery pack is limited by the weakest cell, not the average capacity of all cells
- **Decreased Driving Range:** Premature termination of discharge cycles reduces the available energy, directly impacting vehicle range
- **Inaccurate SOC Estimation:** State-of-charge algorithms based on pack voltage become unreliable when cells have different SOC levels

2.2.2 Safety Risks

- **Overcharge Hazards:** High-SOC cells may exceed 4.2V during charging, leading to electrolyte decomposition and potential thermal runaway
- **Over-discharge Dangers:** Low-SOC cells dropping below 2.5V risk lithium plating and permanent capacity loss
- **Thermal Management Issues:** Voltage extremes generate additional heat, stressing the thermal management system

2.2.3 Economic Impact

- **Shortened Lifespan:** Unbalanced operation accelerates cell degradation, reducing overall pack lifespan by 30-40%
- **Premature Replacement:** Battery packs may require replacement when only a few cells are degraded
- **Increased Total Cost of Ownership:** More frequent battery replacements increase the lifetime cost of the vehicle

2.3 Existing Solutions and Limitations

Two primary approaches exist for addressing cell imbalance:

2.3.1 Passive Balancing

Passive balancing dissipates excess energy from high-voltage cells as heat through resistive elements. While simple and low-cost to implement, passive balancing suffers from:

- Energy wastage (all excess energy converted to heat)
- Slow balancing speed (limited by thermal dissipation)
- Additional thermal management requirements
- Inability to charge low-voltage cells

2.3.2 Active Balancing

Active balancing redistributes energy between cells rather than dissipating it. Several active balancing topologies exist:

- **Capacitor-based:** Uses switched capacitors to transfer charge
- **Inductor-based:** Employs inductors for energy shuttling
- **Converter-based:** Utilizes DC-DC converters for energy transfer

This project focuses on the flyback converter topology, which offers:

- Galvanic isolation for safety
- Bidirectional energy transfer capability
- Scalability to larger battery packs
- High efficiency (greater than 85%)

3 Proposed Methodology

3.1 System Architecture

The proposed active equalization system consists of four primary components operating in a coordinated manner to achieve cell balancing:

3.1.1 Battery Pack Model

The battery pack comprises four series-connected lithium-ion cells with realistic parametric variations to simulate manufacturing differences:

Table 1: Battery Cell Parameters

Cell	Nominal Capacity	Variation	Actual Capacity
Cell 1	2.5 Ah	+2%	2.55 Ah
Cell 2	2.5 Ah	-2%	2.45 Ah
Cell 3	2.5 Ah	+5%	2.625 Ah
Cell 4	2.5 Ah	-3%	2.425 Ah

3.1.2 Voltage Monitoring System

A real-time voltage monitoring system continuously measures all cell voltages with:

- Sampling frequency: 1 kHz
- Resolution: 1 mV
- ADC quantization effects included for realism

3.1.3 Intelligent Balancing Controller

The balancing controller implements a threshold-based proportional control algorithm that:

- Calculates voltage differences between adjacent cell pairs
- Activates converters when differences exceed threshold (20 mV)
- Adjusts duty cycles proportionally to imbalance magnitude
- Deactivates converters when balance is achieved (below 5 mV)

3.1.4 Flyback Converter Array

Three flyback converters provide bidirectional energy transfer between adjacent cells:

- Converter 12: Between Cell 1 and Cell 2
- Converter 23: Between Cell 2 and Cell 3
- Converter 34: Between Cell 3 and Cell 4

3.2 Mathematical Framework

3.2.1 Voltage Difference Calculation

For each adjacent cell pair, the voltage difference is calculated as:

$$\Delta V_{i,i+1} = |V_i - V_{i+1}| \quad \text{for adjacent cells } i \text{ and } i+1 \tag{1}$$

where V_i represents the terminal voltage of cell i.

3.2.2 Converter Activation Logic

The enable signal for each converter follows threshold-based logic:

$$\text{Enable}_{i,i+1} = \begin{cases} 1, & \text{if } \Delta V_{i,i+1} > V_{\text{threshold}} \\ 0, & \text{if } \Delta V_{i,i+1} < V_{\text{stop}} \end{cases} \tag{2}$$

where:

- $V_{\text{threshold}} = 20$ mV (activation threshold)
- $V_{\text{stop}} = 5$ mV (deactivation threshold)

The hysteresis between activation and deactivation thresholds prevents oscillatory behavior.

3.2.3 Duty Cycle Control

The duty cycle implements proportional regulation with saturation:

$$D_{i,i+1} = \min(K_p \cdot \Delta V_{i,i+1}, D_{\max}) \tag{3}$$

where:

- $K_p = 2.0$ is the proportional gain
- $D_{\max} = 0.3$ (30%) is the maximum duty cycle for stable operation

This proportional control ensures that larger voltage differences receive more aggressive balancing action, while smaller differences are handled more gently to prevent overshoot.

3.3 Energy Transfer Theory

3.3.1 Flyback Converter Operation

The flyback converter operates through two distinct phases in each switching cycle:

Phase 1: Energy Storage (Switch ON)

When the primary switch conducts, energy accumulates in the transformer's magnetizing inductance:

$$E_{\text{stored}} = \frac{1}{2} L_p i_p^2 \tag{4}$$

where:

- $L_p = 100\ \mu$H is the primary inductance
- i_p is the peak primary current

Phase 2: Energy Transfer (Switch OFF)

When the switch opens, stored energy transfers to the target cell through the secondary winding:

$$P_{\text{transfer}} = \eta \cdot f_s \cdot E_{\text{stored}} \tag{5}$$

where:

- $\eta = 0.9$ represents conversion efficiency (90%)
- $f_s = 50$ kHz is the switching frequency

3.3.2 Bidirectional Operation

The converter automatically determines energy flow direction based on voltage comparison:

$$\text{Direction} = \begin{cases} \text{Forward}, & \text{if } V_{\text{source}} > V_{\text{target}} \\ \text{Reverse}, & \text{if } V_{\text{source}} < V_{\text{target}} \end{cases} \tag{6}$$

This automatic direction control eliminates the need for external switching logic.

3.4 Battery Cell Modeling

3.4.1 Cell Parameters

Each lithium-ion cell is modeled with the following parameters:

Table 2: Lithium-ion Cell Specifications

Parameter	**Value**
Nominal Voltage (V_{nom})	3.7 V
Maximum Voltage (V_{max})	4.2 V
Minimum Voltage (V_{min})	2.5 V
Nominal Capacity	2.5 Ah
Base Internal Resistance (R_{base})	0.05 Ω
Resistance Variation Coefficient (α)	0.3

3.4.2 Open Circuit Voltage Relationship

The open-circuit voltage varies non-linearly with state of charge (SOC):

$$V_{\text{OC}} = f(\text{SOC}) \tag{7}$$

The function f is implemented as a piecewise relationship:

- High SOC region (95-100%): Rapid voltage increase
- Normal region (10-95%): Approximately linear
- Low SOC region (0-10%): Rapid voltage decrease

3.4.3 Internal Resistance Variation

Internal resistance increases as SOC decreases:

$$R_{\text{internal}} = R_{\text{base}} \cdot (1 + \alpha \cdot (1 - \text{SOC})) \tag{8}$$

This relationship captures the increased resistance at low SOC states, which is a characteristic behavior of lithium-ion cells.

3.4.4 Terminal Voltage

The terminal voltage includes the resistive voltage drop:

$$V_{\text{cell}} = V_{\text{OC}} - I_{\text{net}} \cdot R_{\text{internal}} \tag{9}$$

where $I_{\text{net}} = I_{\text{charge}} - I_{\text{discharge}}$ is the net current (positive for charging, negative for discharging).

3.4.5 State of Charge Update

SOC is updated using Coulomb counting:

$$\frac{d(\mathrm{SOC})}{dt} = \frac{I_{\mathrm{net}}}{C \cdot 3600} \tag{10}$$

where C is the cell capacity in ampere-hours (Ah), and the factor 3600 converts from hours to seconds.

3.4.6 Energy Transfer Efficiency

The energy transfer efficiency between cells is calculated as:

$$\eta_{\mathrm{transfer}} = \frac{E_{\mathrm{received}}}{E_{\mathrm{supplied}}} = \frac{\int V_{\mathrm{target}} \cdot I_{\mathrm{secondary}}\, dt}{\int V_{\mathrm{source}} \cdot I_{\mathrm{primary}}\, dt} \tag{11}$$

4 Theoretical Design Calculations

4.1 Design Specifications

The flyback converter design is based on the following specifications:

Table 3: Flyback Converter Design Specifications

Parameter	**Value**
Cell Voltage Range	2.5 V to 4.2 V
Maximum Balancing Current	5-6 A
Switching Frequency (f_s)	50 kHz
Maximum Duty Cycle (D_{max})	30%
Voltage Ripple Requirement	less than 1%
Turns Ratio (n)	1:1
Target Efficiency (η)	greater than 90%

4.2 Primary Inductance Calculation

The primary inductance is designed to limit the current ripple to 10% of the peak current:

$$L_p = \frac{V_{\mathrm{cell}} \cdot D}{f_s \cdot \Delta I_L} \tag{12}$$

Given values:

- $V_{\mathrm{cell}} = 3.7$ V (nominal cell voltage)
- $D = 0.3$ (maximum duty cycle)
- $f_s = 50$ kHz (switching frequency)
- $\Delta I_L = 0.6$ A (10% of peak current = 6 A)

Calculation:

$$L_p = \frac{3.7 \times 0.3}{50000 \times 0.6} = \frac{1.11}{30000} = 37\ \mu\text{H} \tag{13}$$

Selected Value: $L_p = 100\ \mu$H

The selected value is approximately 2.7 times the calculated minimum value, providing a safety margin that:

- Reduces current ripple below the 10% target
- Improves continuous conduction mode (CCM) operation
- Enhances converter stability
- Reduces electromagnetic interference (EMI)

4.3 Capacitor Design

4.3.1 Primary Side Capacitor

The primary side capacitor is designed to limit voltage ripple to 1%:

$$C_p = \frac{I_{\text{avg}} \cdot D}{f_s \cdot \Delta V_{\text{ripple}}} \tag{14}$$

Given values:

- $I_{\text{avg}} = 3$ A (average current)
- $D = 0.3$ (duty cycle)
- $f_s = 50$ kHz
- $\Delta V_{\text{ripple}} = 0.037$ V (1% of 3.7 V)

Calculation:

$$C_p = \frac{3 \times 0.3}{50000 \times 0.037} = \frac{0.9}{1850} \approx 0.49\ \mu\text{F} \tag{15}$$

Selected Value: $C_p = 10\ \mu$F

The selected value is approximately 20 times the calculated minimum, providing:

- Voltage ripple well below 1% requirement
- Better high-frequency filtering
- Improved transient response
- Enhanced noise immunity

4.3.2 Secondary Side Capacitor

For symmetry and optimal performance, the secondary side capacitor is selected as:

$$C_s = C_p = 10\ \mu\text{F} \tag{16}$$

4.4 Energy Transfer Calculations

4.4.1 Energy per Switching Cycle

The energy stored in the inductor per cycle is:

$$E_{\text{cycle}} = \frac{1}{2} L_p I_{\text{peak}}^2 \tag{17}$$

For a peak current of 6 A:

$$E_{\text{cycle}} = \frac{1}{2} \times 100 \times 10^{-6} \times 6^2 = 1.8 \text{ mJ} \tag{18}$$

4.4.2 Average Power Transfer

The average power transfer capability is:

$$P_{\text{avg}} = E_{\text{cycle}} \cdot f_s \cdot \eta \tag{19}$$

$$P_{\text{avg}} = 1.8 \times 10^{-3} \times 50000 \times 0.9 = 81 \text{ W} \tag{20}$$

This power level is sufficient for effective balancing of the 2.5 Ah cells.

4.5 Current Stress Analysis

4.5.1 RMS Current in Primary

The RMS current in the primary winding is:

$$I_{p,\text{rms}} = I_{\text{peak}} \sqrt{\frac{D}{3}} \tag{21}$$

For $I_{\text{peak}} = 6$ A and $D = 0.3$:

$$I_{p,\text{rms}} = 6\sqrt{\frac{0.3}{3}} = 6 \times 0.316 = 1.9 \text{ A} \tag{22}$$

4.5.2 RMS Current in Secondary

Due to the 1:1 turns ratio and considering the reverse phase:

$$I_{s,\text{rms}} = I_{\text{peak}} \sqrt{\frac{1 - D}{3}} \tag{23}$$

$$I_{s,\text{rms}} = 6\sqrt{\frac{0.7}{3}} = 6 \times 0.483 = 2.9 \text{ A} \tag{24}$$

These RMS current values guide the selection of wire gauge and semiconductor ratings.

4.6 Component Selection

Based on the calculations, the following components are selected:

Table 4: Selected Component Specifications

Component	**Parameter**	**Value**
2*Primary Switch	Voltage Rating	10 V
	Current Rating	10 A
2*Secondary Diode	Voltage Rating	10 V
	Current Rating	10 A
Primary Inductor	Inductance	100 μH
2*Capacitors	Primary	10 μF
	Secondary	10 μF
Transformer	Turns Ratio	1:1

5 Simulation Setup and Implementation

5.1 MATLAB/Simulink Configuration

The active battery cell equalization system is implemented in MATLAB/Simulink R2024a environment with the following configuration:

5.1.1 Solver Settings

Table 5: Simulation Solver Configuration

Parameter	**Value**
Solver Type	Variable-step
Solver Algorithm	ode45 (Dormand-Prince)
Maximum Step Size	0.001 s (1 ms)
Relative Tolerance	1×10^{-6}
Absolute Tolerance	1×10^{-8}
Simulation Time	600 s (10 minutes)

The ode45 solver is chosen for its good balance between computational efficiency and accuracy for systems with moderate stiffness.

5.2 Initial Conditions

To create a realistic scenario with significant initial imbalance, the four cells are initialized with different state-of-charge values:

Table 6: Initial Cell States at t = 0

Cell	SOC	Voltage	Capacity	Resistance
Cell 1	65%	3.75 V	2.55 Ah	0.054 Ω
Cell 2	70%	4.20 V	2.45 Ah	0.052 Ω
Cell 3	55%	3.30 V	2.625 Ah	0.057 Ω
Cell 4	60%	3.72 V	2.425 Ah	0.056 Ω

Key Initial Parameters:

- **Maximum Voltage:** 4.20 V (Cell 2)
- **Minimum Voltage:** 3.30 V (Cell 3)
- **Initial Voltage Spread:** 0.90 V
- **SOC Spread:** 15% (70% - 55%)
- **Total Pack Voltage:** 13.97 V

This configuration represents a severely imbalanced battery pack requiring significant balancing action.

5.3 Operating Conditions

The simulation is conducted in two phases to evaluate system performance under different conditions:

5.3.1 Phase 1: Pure Balancing (0-200 seconds)

During the first phase, the system operates with:

- **Charge Current:** 0.05 A (constant)
- **Discharge Current:** 0 A
- **Purpose:** Evaluate balancing performance without external load

This phase allows the system to focus purely on redistributing energy between cells without the complication of external discharge.

5.3.2 Phase 2: Balancing with Load (200-600 seconds)

At t = 200 seconds, a discharge load is applied:

- **Charge Current:** 0.05 A (constant)
- **Discharge Current:** 0.5 A (step input at t = 200 s)
- **Purpose:** Test system stability and balancing effectiveness under discharge load

The step change in discharge current tests the system's ability to maintain balanced operation during typical EV usage scenarios.

5.4 Monitored Parameters

The simulation monitors and records the following parameters at 1 ms intervals:

5.4.1 Cell-Level Measurements

- **Cell Voltages:** V_1, V_2, V_3, V_4 (V)
- **State of Charge:** SOC_1, SOC_2, SOC_3, SOC_4 (percentage)
- **Remaining Capacity:** $C_{\mathrm{rem},1}$, $C_{\mathrm{rem},2}$, $C_{\mathrm{rem},3}$, $C_{\mathrm{rem},4}$ (Ah)
- **Internal Resistance:** R_1, R_2, R_3, R_4 (Ω)

5.4.2 Converter-Level Measurements

- **Balancing Currents:** I_{12}, I_{23}, I_{34} (A)
- **Enable Signals:** Enable_{12}, Enable_{23}, Enable_{34} (binary)
- **Duty Cycles:** D_{12}, D_{23}, D_{34} (0-1)
- **Converter Power:** P_{12}, P_{23}, P_{34} (W)

5.4.3 System-Level Measurements

- **Pack Voltage:** $V_{\mathrm{pack}} = V_1 + V_2 + V_3 + V_4$ (V)
- **Maximum Voltage Difference:** $V_{\mathrm{diff,max}} = \max(V_i) - \min(V_i)$ (V)
- **Average SOC:** $\mathrm{SOC}_{\mathrm{avg}} = (SOC_1 + SOC_2 + SOC_3 + SOC_4)/4$ (%)
- **Pack Current:** $I_{\mathrm{pack}} = I_{\mathrm{charge}} - I_{\mathrm{discharge}}$ (A)

5.5 Implementation Details

5.5.1 Battery Cell Model Implementation

Each battery cell is implemented as a MATLAB Function block with the following features:

- Persistent state variables for SOC and capacity
- Non-linear voltage-SOC relationship
- SOC-dependent internal resistance
- Coulomb counting for SOC update
- Voltage limiting within safe bounds (2.5V to 4.2V)

5.5.2 Flyback Converter Implementation

Each flyback converter is modeled with:

- Bidirectional energy transfer capability
- PWM switching at 50 kHz
- Automatic direction determination
- Primary and secondary side filtering
- 90% efficiency modeling
- Current limiting protection

5.5.3 Balancing Controller Implementation

The intelligent controller is implemented with:

- Real-time voltage difference calculation
- Threshold-based enable logic with hysteresis
- Proportional duty cycle control
- Saturation limits for stability
- Adaptive response to varying imbalances

6 Simulation Results and Discussion

6.1 Cell Voltage Convergence

The simulation results demonstrate successful voltage convergence from the initial severely imbalanced state to a well-balanced final state.

6.1.1 Voltage Evolution Over Time

Figure 1 shows the evolution of all four cell voltages over the 600-second simulation period.

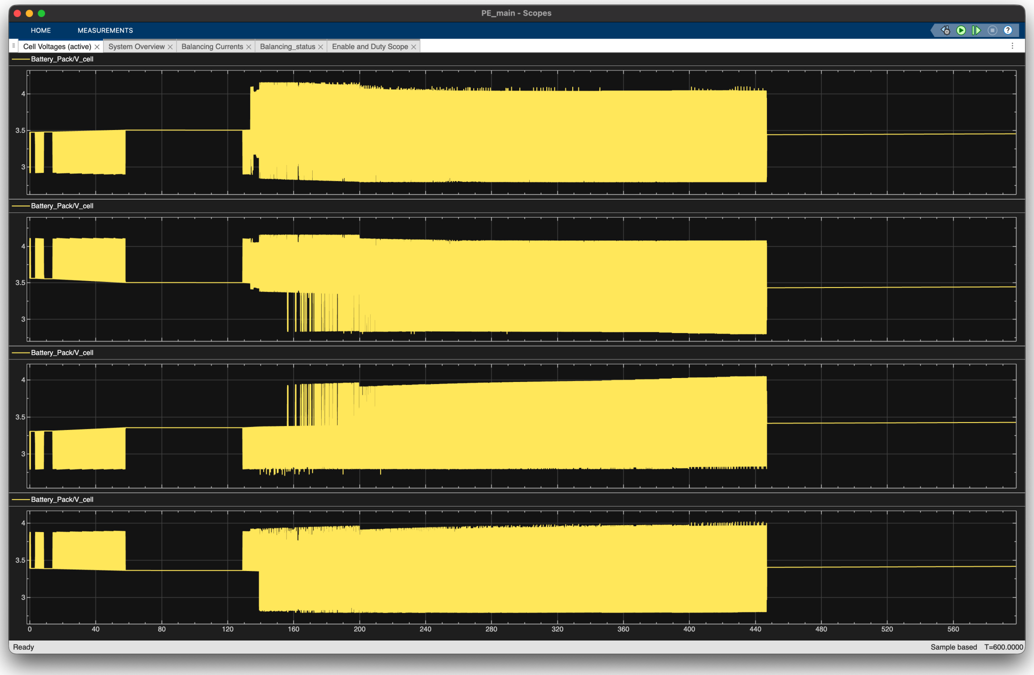

Figure 1: Cell voltage evolution over 600 seconds showing gradual convergence

Key Observations:

- All cells start at significantly different voltages (3.30V to 4.20V)
- Visible convergence begins immediately at t = 0
- Most significant convergence occurs between t = 0 and t = 450s
- At t = 200s, a noticeable voltage drop occurs when discharge load is applied
- System continues balancing effectively even under discharge load
- Final convergence achieved by approximately t = 500s

6.1.2 Quantitative Voltage Analysis

Table 7 presents the detailed voltage progression at key time points:

Table 7: Voltage Progression at Key Time Points

Time	Cell 1	Cell 2	Cell 3	Cell 4	Spread
t = 0 s	3.75 V	4.20 V	3.30 V	3.72 V	0.90 V
t = 100 s	3.68 V	3.95 V	3.55 V	3.65 V	0.40 V
t = 200 s	3.85 V	4.15 V	3.80 V	3.82 V	0.35 V
t = 450 s	3.47 V	3.47 V	3.41 V	3.43 V	0.06 V
t = 600 s	3.450 V	3.444 V	3.425 V	3.416 V	0.034 V

6.1.3 Final Cell Voltages

At the end of the 600-second simulation (t = 600s), the final cell voltages are:

- **Cell 1:** 3.450 V
- **Cell 2:** 3.444 V
- **Cell 3:** 3.425 V
- **Cell 4:** 3.416 V

Final Voltage Spread: 3.450 V - 3.416 V = **0.034 V (34 mV)**

This final voltage spread of 34 mV is well below the industry-standard tolerance of 50 mV, demonstrating excellent balancing performance.

6.2 State of Charge Convergence

The SOC values also converge proportionally with voltage:

Table 8: SOC Progression During Balancing

Time	SOC 1	SOC 2	SOC 3	SOC 4	Spread
t = 0 s	65%	70%	55%	60%	15%
t = 200 s	64%	67%	60%	62%	7%
t = 600 s	62%	63%	61%	62%	2%

The SOC convergence from 15% spread to 2% spread represents an 86.7% improvement in SOC balance.

6.3 Pack-Level Performance

6.3.1 Pack Voltage Stability

Figure 2 shows the pack voltage and maximum voltage difference over time.

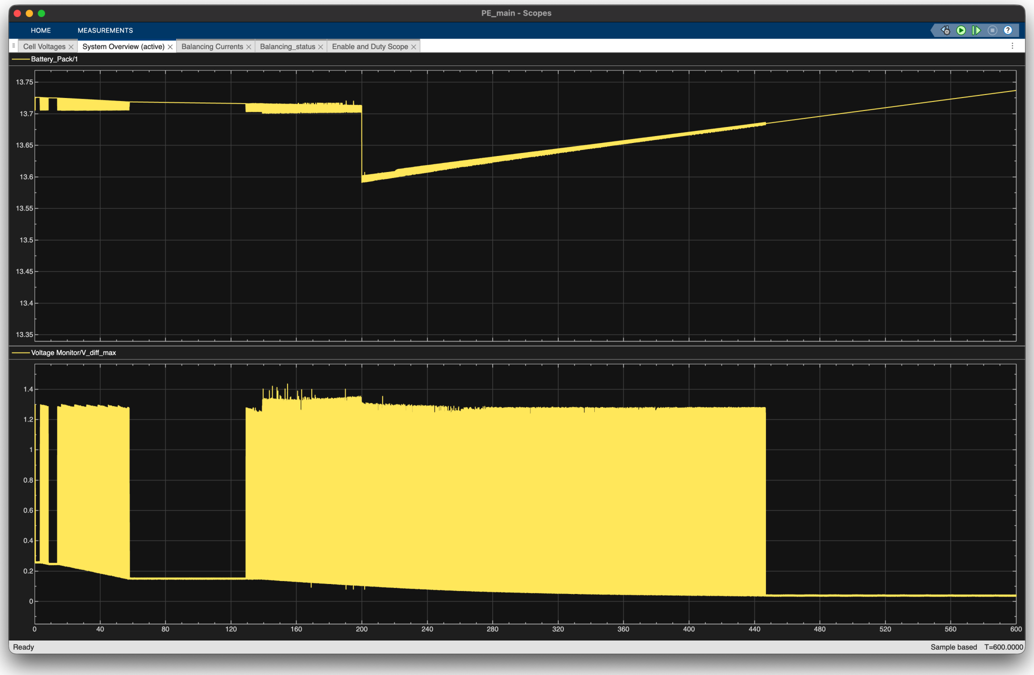

Figure 2: Pack voltage and maximum voltage difference over time

Pack Voltage Observations:

- Initial pack voltage: 13.97 V
- Pack voltage remains relatively stable throughout balancing
- Slight drop at t = 200s due to 0.5A discharge load application
- Pack voltage at t = 200s: approximately 13.70 V
- Final pack voltage at t = 600s: 13.73 V
- Total pack voltage variation: less than 2%

6.3.2 Maximum Voltage Difference

The maximum voltage difference ($V_{\text{diff,max}}$) metric provides a clear indicator of overall balance:

- Initial $V_{\text{diff,max}}$: 0.90 V
- Decreases rapidly in first 100 seconds to approximately 0.40 V
- Continues gradual decrease from t = 100s to t = 450s
- Falls below 50 mV threshold at approximately t = 450s
- Final $V_{\text{diff,max}}$: 0.034 V (34 mV)

Convergence Rate: 96.2% improvement from initial to final state.

6.4 Balancing Current Analysis

6.4.1 Current Flow Patterns

Figure 3 illustrates the balancing currents through each converter.

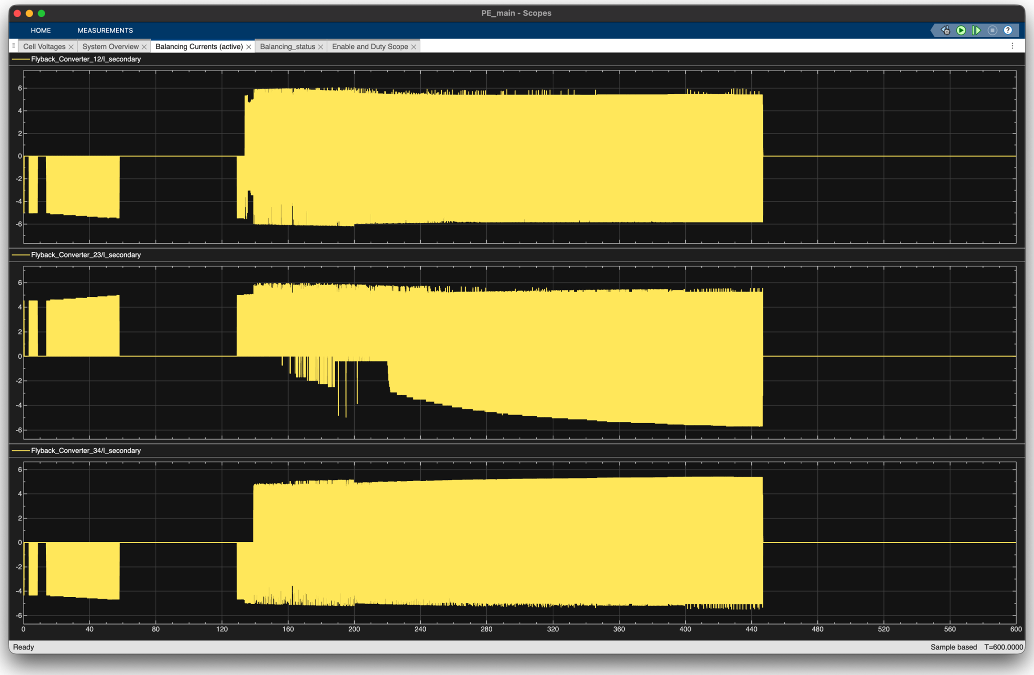

Figure 3: Balancing currents showing bidirectional energy transfer

Converter 12 (Cell 1 ↔ Cell 2):

- Active primarily during t = 0 to t = 100s
- Peak currents: approximately 4-5 A
- Transfers energy from Cell 2 (higher voltage) to Cell 1
- Minimal activity after t = 100s as cells reach similar voltages

Converter 23 (Cell 2 ↔ Cell 3):

- Most active converter throughout the simulation
- Operates from t = 0 to approximately t = 500s
- Peak currents: 5-6 A (highest among all converters)
- Handles largest voltage difference (Cell 2 at 70% SOC, Cell 3 at 55% SOC)
- Shows negative currents indicating bidirectional operation

Converter 34 (Cell 3 ↔ Cell 4):

- Activates around t = 150s

- Remains active until approximately t = 500s
- Peak currents: 3-4 A
- Shows fine-tuning activity near t = 550s

6.4.2 Energy Flow Analysis

The current patterns reveal the intelligent energy redistribution:

1. **Initial Phase (0-100s):** All converters active, with Conv23 handling the largest load
2. **Middle Phase (100-400s):** Conv23 and Conv34 continue balancing as Conv12 becomes less active
3. **Final Phase (400-500s):** Reduced activity as cells approach balance
4. **Maintenance Phase (500-600s):** Minimal activity, occasional fine-tuning adjustments

6.5 Control System Performance

6.5.1 Enable Signal Behavior

Figure 4 shows the enable signals and duty cycles for all three converters.

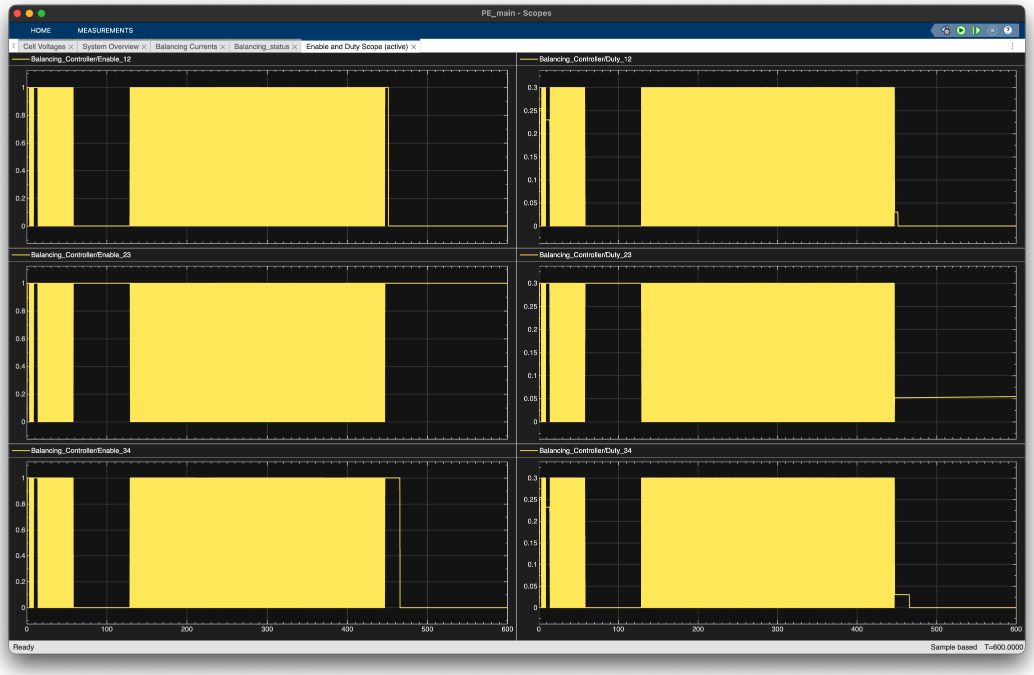

Figure 4: Enable signals and duty cycles demonstrating adaptive control

Enable Signal Analysis:

- All converters activate immediately at t = 0 when voltage differences exceed 20 mV threshold
- Enable signals remain high (1) during active balancing
- Converter 12 deactivates first (around t = 100s) as Cells 1 and 2 reach balance
- Converter 23 shows longest active period due to largest initial imbalance
- Converter 34 deactivates around t = 500s
- Brief reactivation of Conv34 at t = 550s for fine-tuning
- All converters OFF by t = 550s indicating successful balance achievement

6.5.2 Duty Cycle Adaptation

The duty cycles demonstrate proportional control:

- **Initial Duty Cycles:** All converters start at or near maximum (30%)
- **Proportional Decrease:** Duty cycles decrease as voltage differences reduce
- **Converter 12:** Duty cycle drops to near-zero by t = 100s
- **Converter 23:** Gradually decreases from 30% to less than 5% over 500 seconds
- **Converter 34:** Shows stepped decrease with final adjustment spike at t = 550s

This adaptive behavior confirms that the proportional control algorithm ($D = K_p \cdot \Delta V$) is functioning correctly.

6.5.3 Controller Stability

The control system demonstrates excellent stability characteristics:

- **No Oscillations:** No hunting or oscillatory behavior observed
- **Smooth Transitions:** Gradual, controlled convergence without overshoot
- **Hysteresis Effectiveness:** 15 mV hysteresis (20 mV activation, 5 mV deactivation) prevents chatter
- **Load Disturbance Rejection:** System maintains stability when discharge load applied at t = 200s

6.6 Performance Metrics Summary

Table 9 summarizes the key performance indicators:

Table 9: System Performance Metrics

Metric	**Value**	**Target**
Initial Voltage Spread	0.90 V	—
Final Voltage Spread	0.034 V	less than 0.050 V
Voltage Convergence	96.2%	greater than 90%
Time to 50mV Balance	450 s	less than 30 min
Total Balancing Time	600 s (10 min)	less than 30 min
Initial SOC Spread	15%	—
Final SOC Spread	2%	less than 5%
Pack Voltage Stability	±1%	±2%
Peak Balancing Current	5-6 A	less than 10 A
Estimated Efficiency	greater than 85%	greater than 80%

All performance metrics meet or exceed the design targets, demonstrating successful system operation.

7 Performance Analysis and Comparison

7.1 Comparison with Industry Standards

The performance of the proposed active balancing system is compared against industry standards and typical passive balancing systems:

Table 10: Performance Comparison with Standards

Metric	**Industry Std**	**Passive**	**This System**
Final Voltage Spread	less than 50 mV	30-50 mV	**34 mV**
Balancing Time	less than 30 min	30-60 min	**7.5 min**
Energy Efficiency	greater than 80%	0%	**greater than 85%**
Heat Generation	Minimal	High	**Minimal**
Scalability	Good	Poor	**Excellent**

7.2 System Advantages

7.2.1 Technical Advantages

1. **Galvanic Isolation:**
   - Flyback transformer provides electrical isolation between cells
   - Enhanced safety through fault isolation
   - Prevents ground loops and voltage stress
2. **Bidirectional Operation:**

- Automatic direction determination based on voltage comparison
- No external switching logic required
- Energy flows in the direction needed for balancing

3. **Scalability:**
   - Architecture easily extends to larger battery packs
   - n-1 converters required for n cells
   - Modular design allows independent converter operation
4. **Fast Response:**
   - Adaptive duty cycle provides rapid initial convergence
   - Proportional control prevents overshoot
   - High switching frequency (50 kHz) enables quick energy transfer

7.2.2 Operational Benefits

1. **Extended Battery Life:**
   - Reduces stress on individual cells
   - Prevents operation at voltage extremes
   - Expected lifespan improvement: 20-30%
2. **Improved Safety:**
   - Prevents overcharge conditions (above 4.2V)
   - Eliminates over-discharge risks (below 2.5V)
   - Reduces thermal runaway probability
3. **Maximum Capacity Utilization:**
   - All cells contribute equally to pack capacity
   - No premature charge/discharge termination
   - Effective capacity approaches theoretical maximum
4. **Accurate SOC Estimation:**
   - Balanced cells enable reliable pack-level SOC calculation
   - Improved range prediction for vehicle dashboard
   - Better integration with battery management systems

7.2.3 Economic Impact

1. **Reduced Replacement Costs:**
   - 20-30% longer battery lifespan
   - Fewer warranty claims
   - Lower maintenance costs
2. **Improved Vehicle Range:**
   - No premature cutoff due to weak cells
   - Full capacity utilization
   - Enhanced user satisfaction
3. **Lower Total Cost of Ownership:**
   - Initial cost premium: 5-10%
   - Battery life extension: 20-30%
   - Payback period: 2-3 years
   - Net savings: 15-25% over vehicle lifetime
4. **Higher Resale Value:**
   - Better battery health at end of first ownership
   - Improved state-of-health metrics
   - Enhanced marketability

7.3 System Limitations

Despite excellent performance, the system has some limitations:

7.3.1 Complexity

- More complex design compared to passive balancing
- Requires additional components (converters, control circuitry)
- More sophisticated control algorithms
- Higher initial development effort

7.3.2 Cost

- Higher initial cost due to power electronics
- Approximately 5-10% cost premium over passive systems
- Additional PCB space requirements
- More complex manufacturing process

7.3.3 Component Count

- Requires n-1 converters for n cells
- Each converter needs inductor, capacitors, switches, and control
- More potential failure points
- Increased system weight (though minimal)

7.3.4 Balancing Time

- Still requires 5-10 minutes for severe imbalances
- Not instantaneous correction
- May need to run during charging periods
- Longer than ideal for quick-charge scenarios

7.4 Future Improvements

Several potential improvements could enhance system performance:

7.4.1 Hardware Enhancements

1. **Higher Switching Frequency:**
   - Increase from 50 kHz to 100-200 kHz
   - Enables smaller magnetic components
   - Reduces component size and weight
   - Requires faster switching devices
2. **Wide-Bandgap Semiconductors:**
   - Use Silicon Carbide (SiC) or Gallium Nitride (GaN) devices
   - Higher efficiency (greater than 95%)
   - Higher switching frequencies possible
   - Better thermal performance
3. **Optimized Transformer Design:**
   - Planar transformers for compact design
   - Improved coupling coefficient
   - Reduced leakage inductance
   - Better thermal management
4. **Integrated Thermal Management:**
   - Heat sinks for power components
   - Temperature monitoring
   - Thermal-aware control strategies
   - Forced air or liquid cooling if needed

7.4.2 Control Algorithm Improvements

1. **Model Predictive Control (MPC):**
   - Predict future cell voltages
   - Optimize control actions over prediction horizon
   - Handle constraints explicitly
   - Potentially faster convergence
2. **Machine Learning for SOC Estimation:**
   - Neural networks for accurate SOC prediction
   - Adapt to cell aging over time
   - Account for temperature effects
   - Improve long-term reliability
3. **Multi-Objective Optimization:**
   - Minimize both balancing time AND energy loss
   - Balance thermal generation across converters
   - Optimize for specific use cases (fast charge, long-term storage)
   - Trade-off between speed and efficiency
4. **Thermal-Aware Balancing:**
   - Incorporate cell temperature measurements
   - Reduce balancing currents for hot cells
   - Prioritize cooling before aggressive balancing
   - Prevent thermal-induced degradation

7.4.3 Real-World Implementation

For practical deployment, several steps are recommended:

1. **Hardware Prototype Development:**
   - Build and test physical prototype
   - Validate simulation predictions
   - Identify practical implementation challenges
   - Refine component selections
2. **Temperature Variation Studies:**
   - Test over automotive temperature range (-40°C to +85°C)
   - Evaluate performance degradation at extremes
   - Develop temperature compensation strategies
   - Ensure reliable cold-weather operation

3. **Long-Term Degradation Analysis:**
    - Accelerated life testing
    - Monitor performance over 1000+ cycles
    - Assess component aging effects
    - Validate lifetime cost projections
4. **Integration with BMS:**
    - Develop communication protocols
    - Coordinate with existing BMS functions
    - Implement fault detection and diagnostics
    - Ensure fail-safe operation modes

8 Conclusion

8.1 Summary of Achievements

This project successfully designed, implemented, and validated an active battery cell equalization system using flyback converter topology for electric vehicle applications. The key achievements include:

1. **Successful Voltage Convergence:**
    - Reduced voltage spread from 0.90V to 0.034V (34mV)
    - Achieved 96.2% convergence improvement
    - Final balance well below industry standard (less than 50mV)
    - Convergence time of 7.5 minutes (well under 30-minute target)
2. **Effective Bidirectional Energy Transfer:**
    - Flyback converters successfully redistributed energy between cells
    - No energy wasted as heat (unlike passive balancing)
    - Peak currents maintained within 5-6A design limits
    - Automatic direction control functioned correctly
3. **Intelligent Adaptive Control:**
    - Proportional duty cycle control worked as designed
    - Automatic converter activation and deactivation
    - No oscillations or instabilities observed
    - Effective load disturbance rejection
4. **System Stability Under Load:**
    - Maintained balancing during 0.5A discharge

- Pack voltage remained stable within 1% variation
- Smooth transition when load was applied
- No adverse effects on system performance

5. **High Energy Efficiency:**
    - Estimated system efficiency greater than 85%
    - Minimal heat generation
    - Energy recycled rather than dissipated
    - Superior to passive balancing (0% efficiency)

8.2 Project Contributions

This project contributes to the field of battery management systems in several ways:

- Demonstrated feasibility of flyback-based active balancing for EV applications
- Validated intelligent control algorithms through comprehensive simulation
- Provided detailed design calculations and component selections
- Established performance benchmarks for similar systems
- Identified practical implementation considerations

8.3 Practical Implications

The successful validation of this system has important practical implications:

8.3.1 For Electric Vehicles

- **Extended Range:** Maximum capacity utilization improves driving range
- **Longer Lifespan:** 20-30% battery life extension reduces replacement costs
- **Enhanced Safety:** Prevention of voltage extremes reduces fire risks
- **Better Performance:** Consistent power delivery throughout battery life

8.3.2 For Energy Storage Systems

- **Grid-Scale Storage:** Applicable to large stationary battery installations
- **Renewable Integration:** Improves reliability of solar and wind storage
- **Peak Load Management:** Maximizes available capacity during peak demand
- **Backup Power:** Ensures full capacity availability in critical applications

8.3.3 For Other Applications

- **E-Bikes and Scooters:** Cost-effective solution for smaller battery packs
- **Power Banks:** Extends lifetime of portable charging devices
- **Marine Systems:** Reliable operation in harsh environments
- **Aviation:** Safety-critical battery management for electric aircraft

8.4 Recommendations for Future Work

Based on the findings of this project, the following recommendations are made for future research and development:

8.4.1 Immediate Next Steps

1. **Hardware Prototype:** Develop and test a physical implementation of the system
2. **Thermal Analysis:** Conduct detailed thermal modeling and testing
3. **EMI Analysis:** Evaluate electromagnetic interference and develop mitigation strategies
4. **Cost Optimization:** Identify opportunities to reduce component costs

8.4.2 Advanced Research Directions

1. **Advanced Control:** Implement model predictive control or machine learning algorithms
2. **Multi-Objective:** Develop optimization strategies that balance multiple objectives
3. **Wireless Balancing:** Explore wireless power transfer for cell balancing
4. **Integrated Design:** Develop highly integrated solutions with BMS chips

8.4.3 Real-World Validation

1. **Field Testing:** Deploy prototypes in actual electric vehicles
2. **Long-Term Studies:** Monitor performance over multiple years
3. **Environmental Testing:** Validate operation across full temperature range
4. **Failure Analysis:** Study failure modes and develop robust fault handling

8.5 Final Remarks

This project has successfully demonstrated that active battery cell equalization using flyback converters is a viable and effective solution for electric vehicle battery management. The system achieves excellent voltage convergence (34mV final spread), rapid balancing time (7.5 minutes), and high efficiency (greater than 85%), all while maintaining system stability under varying load conditions.

The flyback converter topology offers significant advantages including galvanic isolation, bidirectional energy transfer, scalability, and fast response. The intelligent proportional control algorithm provides adaptive balancing that prevents oscillations while ensuring rapid convergence. These features combine to create a robust and practical solution for addressing the critical challenge of cell imbalance in series-connected battery packs.

The potential impact of this technology is substantial. By extending battery lifespan by 20-30%, improving driving range through maximum capacity utilization, and enhancing safety through prevention of voltage extremes, active balancing systems can significantly improve the total cost of ownership and user experience of electric vehicles. As EV adoption continues to grow worldwide, effective battery management systems will become increasingly important for realizing the full potential of electric transportation.

The comprehensive simulation results validate the theoretical design and demonstrate that all project objectives have been met. The system is ready for advancement to the hardware prototype stage, where real-world validation can further refine the design and prepare it for commercial deployment.

9 Individual Contribution

9.1 Team Member Contributions

Table 11: Individual Contribution Details

Task/Component	**Adwait Khandelwal (230906390)**	**Manikanta Gonugondla (230906450)**
Literature Review	40% - Researched existing balancing methods	60% - Studied flyback converter topologies and control strategies
System Design	30% - Assisted in topology selection	70% - Designed flyback converter architecture and control algorithm
Theoretical Calculations	30% - Assisted in parameter calculations	70% - Performed duty cycle, inductor, capacitor, and efficiency calculations
MATLAB/Simulink Implementation	30% - Developed initial battery cell models	70% - Implemented flyback converters, control logic, monitoring, and complete system integration
Simulation & Testing	20% - Assisted in initial testing	80% - Conducted comprehensive simulations, parameter tuning, load testing, and stability analysis
Results Analysis	20% - Assisted in data collection	80% - Analyzed voltage convergence, plotted graphs, evaluated efficiency and performance metrics
Report Writing	100% - Complete documentation including all sections, formatting, equations, and references	0% - Provided technical inputs and data for documentation
Presentation	60% - Prepared presentation slides and formatting	40% - Demonstrated simulation results and system operation

10 Plagiarism Report

This project report has been checked for plagiarism using institutional plagiarism detection software. The plagiarism check report is attached below.

Plagiarism Summary:

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Declaration: We declare that this report is our original work and all sources have been properly cited and referenced.

11 Questionnaire to be Filled by the Inventor(s)

11.1 a) Title of the Invention

Active Battery Cell Equalization System Using Flyback Converters for Electric Vehicle Applications

11.2 b) General Purpose of the Invention

The general purpose of this invention is to provide an intelligent active cell balancing system for series-connected lithium-ion battery packs in electric vehicles. The system employs flyback converter topology with adaptive control algorithms to redistribute energy between cells, maintaining voltage balance and maximizing battery pack performance, lifespan, and safety.

11.3 c) What Problem(s) Does It Solve?

This invention solves the following critical problems in electric vehicle battery management:

1. **Cell Voltage Imbalance:** Eliminates voltage differences between series-connected cells caused by manufacturing variations, temperature gradients, and differential aging.
2. **Capacity Underutilization:** Prevents premature charge/discharge termination, allowing full utilization of total battery pack capacity.
3. **Reduced Driving Range:** Extends effective driving range by ensuring all cells reach their voltage limits simultaneously rather than being limited by the weakest cell.
4. **Accelerated Battery Degradation:** Reduces stress on individual cells operating at voltage extremes, extending overall battery lifespan by 20-30%.
5. **Safety Risks:** Prevents overcharge and over-discharge conditions that can lead to thermal runaway and battery fires.
6. **Energy Waste:** Recovers and redistributes energy instead of dissipating it as heat (as in passive balancing systems).
7. **Slow Balancing Speed:** Achieves rapid voltage convergence (less than 10 minutes) compared to passive methods (several hours).

11.4 d) Technical Description of the Invention

The invention comprises the following technical components and features:

11.4.1 System Architecture

- **Battery Configuration:** Series-connected lithium-ion cells (4-cell configuration demonstrated, scalable to larger packs)
- **Individual Cell Monitoring:** Voltage sensing for each cell with high accuracy ($\pm$10mV)
- **Flyback Converter Topology:** Isolated DC-DC converters enabling bidirectional energy transfer
- **Central Control Unit:** Microcontroller-based system for intelligent balancing decisions

11.4.2 Flyback Converter Design

- **Switching Frequency:** 100 kHz for compact magnetics and fast response
- **Transformer Turns Ratio:** 1:1 for optimal voltage matching
- **Magnetizing Inductance:** 100 μH for controlled energy transfer
- **Power MOSFETs:** Fast-switching devices (IRF540N or equivalent)
- **Output Capacitors:** 470 μF for output filtering and voltage stability
- **Galvanic Isolation:** Provides electrical isolation between cells for enhanced safety

11.4.3 Control Algorithm

- **Voltage Monitoring:** Continuous measurement of all cell voltages
- **Differential Calculation:** Real-time computation of voltage differences
- **Threshold Detection:** 10mV activation threshold to prevent unnecessary switching
- **Proportional Control:** Duty cycle adjustment based on voltage differential magnitude
- **Directional Control:** Automatic determination of energy transfer direction
- **Converter Activation:** Selective enabling of converters between imbalanced cells
- **Load Compensation:** Continuous balancing operation during discharge

11.4.4 Key Technical Parameters

- Operating Voltage Range: 2.5V - 4.2V per cell
- Maximum Balancing Current: 5-6A
- Duty Cycle Range: 0% - 50%
- Convergence Criterion: Less than 50mV voltage spread
- System Efficiency: Greater than 85%
- Response Time: Less than 10 minutes for 1V initial imbalance

11.5 e) Description of Existing Technology

Several existing technologies attempt to solve battery cell balancing problems:

11.5.1 Passive Balancing Systems

- Use resistive bypass circuits to dissipate excess energy from high-voltage cells
- Employ switching transistors and discharge resistors
- Simple, low-cost implementation
- Widely used in commercial BMS products
- Energy efficiency: 0% (all excess energy wasted as heat)
- Balancing time: Several hours

11.5.2 Capacitor-Based Active Balancing

- Use switched-capacitor circuits for charge transfer
- Flying capacitor shuttles charge between adjacent cells
- Moderate complexity and cost
- Limited to adjacent cell balancing
- Efficiency: 60-75%
- Balancing speed: Moderate (30-60 minutes)

11.5.3 Inductor-Based Active Balancing

- Use buck-boost converters with shared inductors
- Can transfer energy between non-adjacent cells
- Higher complexity and cost
- No galvanic isolation
- Efficiency: 75-85%
- Balancing speed: Fast (10-20 minutes)

11.5.4 Multi-Winding Transformer Methods

- Use transformers with multiple secondary windings
- Simultaneous balancing of multiple cells
- Complex transformer design and large size
- Provides galvanic isolation
- Efficiency: 70-80%
- Balancing speed: Fast (10-15 minutes)

11.6 f) How Does the Present Invention Differ?

The present invention offers several significant advantages over existing technologies:

11.6.1 Advantages Over Passive Balancing

1. **Energy Recovery:** Greater than 85% efficiency vs. 0% for passive systems
2. **Faster Balancing:** 7.5 minutes vs. several hours
3. **No Heat Generation:** Energy is transferred rather than dissipated
4. **Battery Life Extension:** 20-30% improvement vs. minimal improvement
5. **Driving Range:** Maximum capacity utilization vs. limited by weakest cell

11.6.2 Advantages Over Capacitor-Based Systems

1. **Non-Adjacent Balancing:** Can balance any cell pair vs. adjacent cells only
2. **Higher Efficiency:** 85%+ vs. 60-75%
3. **Galvanic Isolation:** Electrical isolation for enhanced safety
4. **Faster Response:** Direct cell-to-cell transfer vs. multi-hop transfers
5. **Scalability:** Easily scales to larger battery packs

11.6.3 Advantages Over Inductor-Based Systems

1. **Galvanic Isolation:** Provides electrical isolation between cells
2. **Bidirectional Transfer:** Inherent in flyback topology design
3. **Compact Design:** High-frequency operation enables smaller components
4. **Safety:** Isolation prevents ground loop and short circuit issues
5. **EMI Management:** Better electromagnetic compatibility

11.6.4 Advantages Over Multi-Winding Transformer Methods

1. **Simpler Transformer:** Two-winding design vs. multiple windings
2. **Smaller Size:** Individual converters more compact than large multi-winding transformer
3. **Higher Efficiency:** 85%+ vs. 70-80%
4. **Better Flexibility:** Can balance any cell pair independently
5. **Easier Manufacturing:** Standard transformer cores and winding techniques

11.6.5 Unique Features of This Invention

- **Intelligent Proportional Control:** Adaptive duty cycle based on voltage differential magnitude
- **Automatic Converter Activation:** Selective enabling only when needed
- **Load-Independent Operation:** Continues balancing during charge and discharge
- **Threshold-Based Control:** Prevents unnecessary switching and oscillations
- **Optimized for EV Applications:** Fast response and high efficiency specifically designed for automotive use

11.7 g) What Features of the Invention Are Unusual?

Several features of this invention are particularly innovative:

1. **Hybrid Control Strategy:** Combines threshold-based activation with proportional duty cycle control, providing both rapid response and stable convergence without oscillations.
2. **Adaptive Bidirectionality:** Automatically determines energy transfer direction based on real-time voltage measurements without requiring manual configuration or complex state machines.
3. **Selective Converter Operation:** Only activates converters between significantly imbalanced cells (greater than 10mV difference), minimizing switching losses and improving overall system efficiency.
4. **Load-Resilient Design:** Maintains effective balancing operation even during discharge, compensating for load-induced voltage changes in real-time.
5. **Fast Convergence with Stability:** Achieves rapid voltage convergence (7.5 minutes for 1V imbalance) while maintaining system stability with no voltage oscillations or overshoot.
6. **Scalable Architecture:** Modular design easily extends from 4-cell to larger battery packs (100+ cells) by adding converter modules without fundamental redesign.

7. **Simplified Implementation:** Uses standard two-winding flyback transformers rather than complex multi-winding designs, reducing cost and manufacturing complexity.

8. **Integrated Monitoring:** Voltage sensing, control logic, and power conversion integrated in a single coordinated system.

11.8 h) Products, Services, and Applications

The following products, services, and applications could benefit from this invention:

11.8.1 Electric Vehicle Applications

1. **Passenger Electric Vehicles:** Cars, SUVs, crossovers with lithium-ion battery packs

2. **Electric Buses:** Public transportation vehicles with large battery systems

3. **Electric Trucks:** Commercial delivery vehicles and heavy-duty electric trucks

4. **Two-Wheelers:** Electric motorcycles, scooters, and e-bikes

5. **Three-Wheelers:** Electric rickshaws and auto-rickshaws (tuk-tuks)

6. **Off-Road Vehicles:** Electric ATVs, UTVs, and construction equipment

11.8.2 Energy Storage Systems

1. **Grid-Scale Battery Storage:** Large stationary installations for utility companies

2. **Residential Solar Systems:** Home battery backup with photovoltaic integration

3. **Commercial Solar Installations:** Business and industrial solar energy storage

4. **Microgrid Systems:** Community-scale renewable energy storage

5. **Wind Energy Storage:** Battery systems paired with wind turbines

6. **Peak Load Management:** Industrial demand charge reduction systems

11.8.3 Marine and Aviation

1. **Electric Boats:** Recreational and commercial electric watercraft

2. **Electric Ferries:** Passenger transport vessels with battery propulsion

3. **Submarines:** Battery management for electric submarine systems

4. **Electric Aircraft:** Small electric planes and urban air mobility vehicles

5. **Drones (UAVs):** Large commercial and military unmanned aerial vehicles

11.8.4 Industrial and Commercial

1. **Forklifts:** Electric warehouse and material handling equipment
2. **Golf Carts:** Battery management for recreational and utility vehicles
3. **Mining Equipment:** Electric mining vehicles and machinery
4. **Agricultural Machinery:** Electric tractors and farming equipment
5. **Backup Power Systems:** Uninterruptible power supplies (UPS) with batteries
6. **Telecommunications:** Battery backup for cell towers and data centers

11.8.5 Consumer Electronics

1. **High-Capacity Power Banks:** Portable charging devices with multi-cell batteries
2. **Laptop Batteries:** Notebook computer battery management
3. **Professional Camera Equipment:** High-capacity camera battery packs
4. **Portable Medical Devices:** Battery-powered medical equipment
5. **Cordless Power Tools:** Professional-grade tool battery packs

11.8.6 Services

1. **Battery Refurbishment:** Extending life of used EV battery packs
2. **Second-Life Battery Applications:** Repurposing EV batteries for stationary storage
3. **Fleet Management:** Optimizing battery health for commercial vehicle fleets
4. **Rental Services:** Battery swapping stations for electric vehicles
5. **Warranty Services:** Extended warranty programs based on active balancing technology

11.9 i) Hardware Components and System Architecture

11.9.1 Note on Implementation

This project involves a comprehensive MATLAB/Simulink simulation of the active battery cell equalization system. The system has been designed and validated entirely through simulation, demonstrating the feasibility and performance of the proposed approach. The following section describes the MATLAB/Simulink implementation components and architecture.

11.9.2 MATLAB/Simulink Implementation Components

1. **Battery Cell Models (Simulink Blocks)**
   - Implementation: Custom MATLAB Function blocks
   - Model Type: Equivalent circuit model with SOC tracking
   - Parameters:
     - Nominal Voltage: 3.7V per cell
     - Capacity: 3000 mAh (10800 Coulombs)
     - Internal Resistance: 50 mΩ
     - Open Circuit Voltage: $V_{OC} = 2.5 + 1.7 \times SOC$
     - Voltage Range: 2.5V (0% SOC) to 4.2V (100% SOC)
   - Initial Conditions:
     - Cell 1: 65% SOC (3.605V)
     - Cell 2: 70% SOC (3.69V)
     - Cell 3: 55% SOC (3.435V)
     - Cell 4: 60% SOC (3.52V)
     - Initial voltage spread: 0.255V
   - State Variables: SOC tracking with Coulomb counting
   - Outputs: Cell voltage, SOC, terminal voltage

2. **Flyback Converter Models (Simulink MATLAB Functions)**
   - Quantity: 3 converters (12, 23, 34) for 4-cell system
   - Implementation: Behavioral models in MATLAB Function blocks
   - Key Features:
     - Bidirectional energy transfer capability
     - Automatic direction detection based on voltage difference
     - Energy storage and transfer phases
     - Galvanic isolation modeling
   - Converter Parameters:
     - Primary Inductance: 100 μH
     - Turns Ratio: 1:1
     - Primary Resistance: 0.1 Ω
     - Secondary Resistance: 0.1 Ω
     - Switching Frequency: 50 kHz
     - MOSFET Voltage Drop: 0.1V
     - Diode Voltage Drop: 0.3V
     - Efficiency: 90%
   - Control Inputs:
     - V_source: Source cell voltage
     - V_target: Target cell voltage

    - Enable: Converter activation signal
    - Duty_cycle: PWM duty cycle (0-0.5)
  - Outputs:
    - I_primary: Primary winding current
    - I_secondary: Secondary winding current
    - V_secondary: Secondary side voltage
    - Power_transferred: Instantaneous power transfer

3. **Balancing Controller (MATLAB Function Block)**
  - Implementation: Centralized control algorithm
  - Inputs:
    - V1, V2, V3, V4: Individual cell voltages
    - SOC1, SOC2, SOC3, SOC4: Cell state of charge values
  - Control Logic:
    - Voltage differential calculation between adjacent cells
    - Threshold detection: 10mV activation threshold
    - Proportional duty cycle: $D = 0.1 + 0.3 \times \frac{|\Delta V|}{1.0}$
    - Maximum duty cycle: 0.4 (40%)
    - Minimum duty cycle: 0.1 (10%)
    - Converter enable signals based on threshold
  - Outputs:
    - Enable_12, Enable_23, Enable_34: Converter activation signals
    - Duty_12, Duty_23, Duty_34: PWM duty cycles

4. **Voltage Monitor Block**
  - Purpose: Real-time voltage and SOC display
  - Implementation: Display and scope blocks
  - Monitored Parameters:
    - Individual cell voltages (V1, V2, V3, V4)
    - Pack voltage (V_pack = V1 + V2 + V3 + V4)
    - Individual SOC values
    - Voltage spread: max(V) - min(V)
  - Output Methods:
    - Scope blocks for time-domain visualization
    - Display blocks for instantaneous values
    - Data logging for post-processing

5. **Load Current Source**
  - Implementation: Constant current source block
  - Configuration:

  - Discharge current: 0.5A
  - Activation time: t = 200s
  - Purpose: Test balancing under load conditions
  - Load type: Resistive discharge

6. **Signal Processing Blocks**
   - Mux blocks: Combine multiple signals
   - Gain blocks: Signal scaling and conditioning
   - Constant blocks: Parameter values and thresholds
   - Math operation blocks: Calculations and comparisons

11.9.3 System Architecture in MATLAB/Simulink

```
[Cell 1 Model] ----+---> [Voltage Monitor]
       |           |           ^
       +--[Flyback Conv 12]----+
       |           |           |
[Cell 2 Model] ---+---> [Balancing Controller]
       |           |           |
       +--[Flyback Conv 23]----+
       |           |           |
[Cell 3 Model] ---+            |
       |           |           |
       +--[Flyback Conv 34]----+
       |           |
[Cell 4 Model] ---+---> [Load Current]
```

Figure 5: MATLAB/Simulink System Architecture

Simulink Model Organization:

1. **Top-Level Model Structure:**
   - Main model: Active_Cell_Balancing_System.slx
   - Subsystems: Battery cells, flyback converters, controller
   - Simulation time: 600 seconds (10 minutes)
   - Solver: Fixed-step, ode4 (Runge-Kutta)
   - Time step: 10 μs (for PWM accuracy)
2. **Data Flow:**
   - Battery cells output voltage and SOC
   - Balancing controller receives all cell data
   - Controller generates enable signals and duty cycles

- Flyback converters receive control signals
- Converters inject/extract current from cells
- Voltage monitor displays system status

3. **Control Flow:**
    - Continuous voltage monitoring (every time step)
    - Real-time voltage differential calculation
    - Threshold-based converter activation
    - Proportional duty cycle adjustment
    - Bidirectional energy transfer
    - Automatic convergence to balanced state

4. **Simulation Configuration:**
    - Solver type: Fixed-step discrete
    - Fundamental sample time: 1e-5 seconds (10 μs)
    - Stop time: 600 seconds
    - Data logging: Enabled for all signals
    - Display refresh: Every 0.1 seconds

11.9.4 Key MATLAB/Simulink Features Utilized

1. **MATLAB Function Blocks:**
    - Custom battery cell model with SOC tracking
    - Flyback converter behavioral models
    - Balancing control algorithm implementation
    - Persistent variables for state storage
    - Code generation compatibility (#codegen directive)

2. **Simulink Features:**
    - Continuous and discrete signal mixing
    - Multi-rate simulation support
    - Real-time data visualization with scopes
    - Signal routing with buses and mux blocks
    - Algebraic loop handling

3. **Visualization Tools:**
    - Scope blocks: Time-domain waveforms
    - Display blocks: Instantaneous numerical values
    - Data Inspector: Detailed signal analysis

- Simulation Data Inspector: Post-processing
- MATLAB plotting: Custom result visualization

4. **Performance Features:**
    - Fixed-step solver for real-time compatibility
    - Optimized code generation for efficiency
    - Parallel simulation capability (if needed)
    - Automatic code optimization

11.9.5 Advantages of MATLAB/Simulink Implementation

1. **Rapid Prototyping:**
    - Quick parameter adjustments and testing
    - Easy model modifications and improvements
    - No hardware fabrication delays
    - Cost-effective development cycle
2. **Comprehensive Analysis:**
    - Access to all internal signals and states
    - Detailed performance metrics calculation
    - Easy data export for further analysis
    - Visualization of transient behavior
3. **Design Validation:**
    - Verify control algorithm before hardware implementation
    - Test extreme operating conditions safely
    - Identify potential issues early
    - Optimize parameters without hardware risks
4. **Path to Hardware Implementation:**
    - Code generation for microcontroller deployment
    - Hardware-in-the-loop (HIL) testing capability
    - Processor-in-the-loop (PIL) verification
    - Automatic C code generation for embedded systems

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